# DHL return label for returns without outbound DHL shipment (12.11.2026)

PDF version · Code · based on Return label email 29.10.

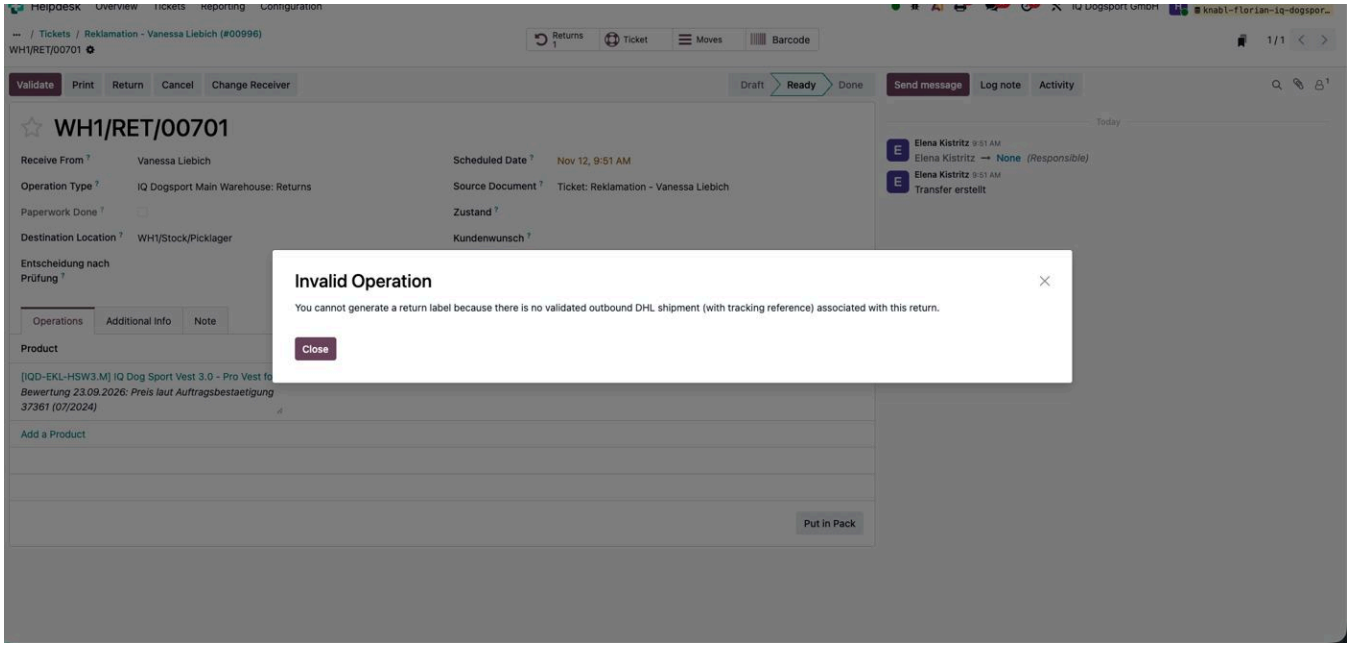
> **Status 12.11.2026: LIVE in Production.** Tested on WH1/RET/00701 (ticket #00996, Vanessa Liebich): DHL return label 545935501591 created without outbound DHL shipment. Owner: Hamza.

## 1. Problem

For returns created from a Helpdesk ticket (complaint/warranty) the DHL return label could not be created:

- Button *Retourenlabel senden* was **not visible**.
- BrowseInfo buttons (*Get Receivers* / *Print Return Label*) failed: *"You cannot generate a return label because there is no validated outbound DHL shipment (with tracking reference) associated with this return."*

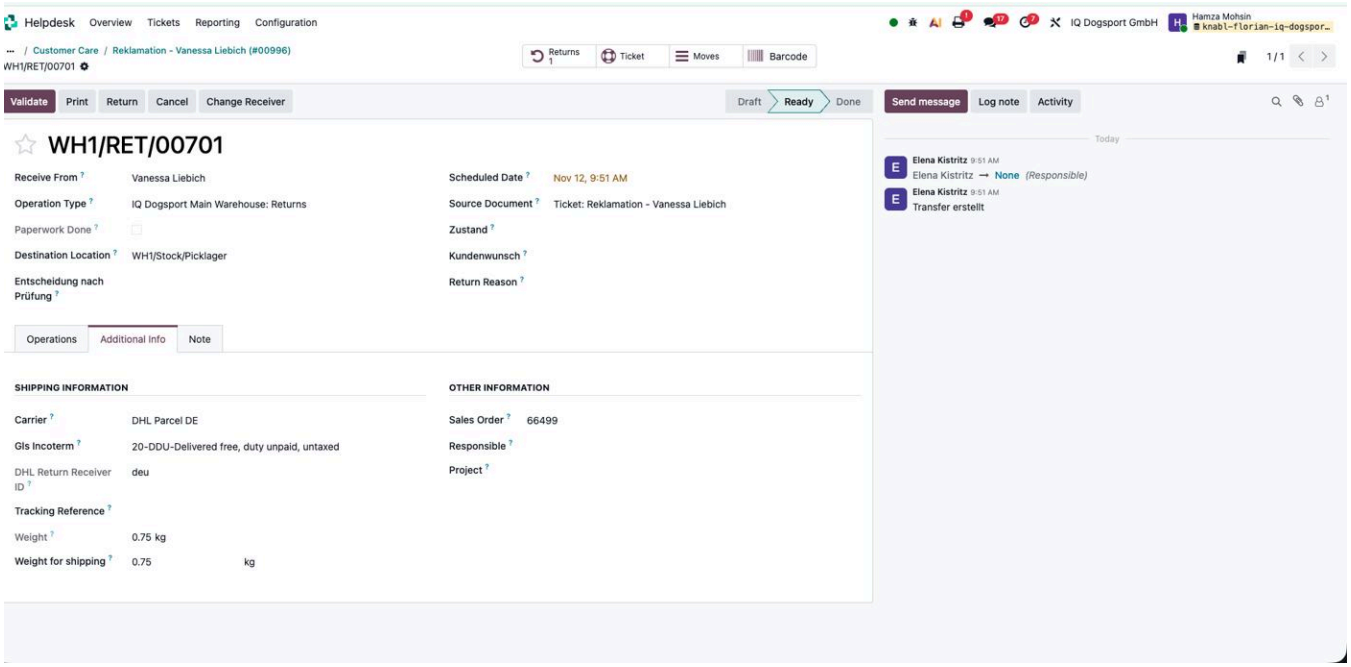
Affected: every return without an outbound DHL delivery in Odoo – returns from tickets, orders shipped with GLS, orders from before the DHL go-live (27.10.2026).



Production WH1/RET/00701 (ticket #00996) – BrowseInfo error

## 2. Cause

| Part | Why it failed |
|---|---|
| Our button view | Hidden when `not is_return_picking`. Odoo only sets this for returns made with the *Return* button (field `return_id`). Returns from tickets have no `return_id` (checked: WH1/RET/00701 return_id empty, sale_id 16497). |
| Our server action v1 | Same check ( `not picking.is_return_picking` ) → "not an open return". |
| BrowseInfo connector | The check "outbound DHL shipment with tracking" is only in its buttons: `stock_picking.py → action_open_return_receiver_wizard` and `delivery_carrier.py → dhl_parcel_de_get_return_label`. |
| DHL API call | `dhl_request.py:753 create_return_shipment(carrier, picking)` does **not** use the outbound shipment – only the return's contact (address, email, phone), `dhl_return_receiver_id` (default deu), sales order name/total (or return name / 10 €), weight (default 1 kg). |




Return from ticket: carrier DHL Parcel DE and receiver deu are set (by rule "IQ – Return: DHL carrier for Germany"), but no outbound shipment

## 3. Fix (automation only – no module, no new fields, BrowseInfo unchanged)

| Case | Created by | Result |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Return button on a DHL delivery | BrowseInfo creates label – unchanged |
| 2 | Return button on old / GLS delivery (no DHL tracking) | our action creates label directly |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 3 | Return from Helpdesk ticket (no return_id) | our action creates label directly |

### 3a. View “IQ – Send return label button”

`not is_return_picking` → `not carrier_id`. Buttons show on open incoming transfers with a carrier.

```
<!--
Odoo 19 - inherited view (PRODUCTION) - v2, live since 12.11.2026 (v1: 29.10.2026)
View Name:              IQ – Send return label button
View Type:              Form
Model:                  Transfer (stock.picking)
Inherited View:         stock.picking.form  (External ID stock.view_picking_form, the one
WITHOUT parent)
View inheritance mode:  Extension View
Access Rights:          empty (all users)
name = id of the server action "Send return label" (production 1777 - NOT the staging id
1774)
v2: "not is_return_picking" replaced by "not carrier_id" - returns created from tickets
have no return_id,
    so is_return_picking is False and the button was hidden. The server action checks if it
is really a return.
-->
<xpath expr="//header" position="inside">
    <button name="1777" type="action" string="Retourenlabel senden" class="btn-primary"
invisible="state == 'done' or picking_type_code != 'incoming' or not carrier_id or
carrier_tracking_ref"/>
    <button name="1777" type="action" string="Retourenlabel erneut senden" class="btn-
secondary" confirm="Für diese Retoure wurde bereits ein Label erstellt. Erneut an den
Kunden senden?" invisible="state == 'done' or picking_type_code != 'incoming' or not
carrier_id or not carrier_tracking_ref"/>
</xpath>
```

### 3b. Server action “Send return label” (production 1777)

- “Return” = `is_return_picking` **or** operation type is a Returns type (`return_picking_type_id` of another type) – supplier receipts are still refused.
- Outbound DHL shipment found (same lookup as BrowseInfo) → `print_return_label()` as before.
- Not found → carrier must be `dhl_parcel_de`; receiver empty + customer in DE → `deu`; other countries → clear message (only Germany set up, see Finland / Retoure International).

- Calls `env["dhl.request"].create_return_shipment(carrier, picking)`, saves PDF like BrowseInfo (`LabelReturn-dhl_parcel_de-<tracking>.pdf`, description “System generated DHL Return Label”), writes Tracking Reference, chatter note *“(IQ: created without outbound DHL shipment)”*.
- Email part (template DE/EN, ticket, forms) unchanged.

```
 # Odoo 19 - Server Action (PRODUCTION id 1777, staging id 1774)
# Name:  Send return label   - v2, live since 12.11.2026 (v1: 29.10.2026)
# Model: Transfer (stock.picking), Type: Execute Code, "Create Contextual Action" done
# Used by the buttons "Retourenlabel senden" / "Retourenlabel erneut senden" (view "IQ –
Send return label button").
#
# 1. uses the existing LabelReturn PDF, or creates it:
#    a) return HAS an outbound DHL shipment (tracking ref) -> BrowseInfo connector as
before (print_return_label)
#    b) NO outbound DHL shipment (returns from Helpdesk tickets, old/GLS orders)
#       -> calls the connector's DHL request directly:
env["dhl.request"].create_return_shipment(carrier, picking)
#          (the "no validated outbound DHL shipment" check is only in the connector's
buttons, not in this method)
#          and saves the PDF exactly like the connector (name LabelReturn-..., description,
chatter note)
#    "Return" = created with the Return button (is_return_picking) OR operation type is a
Returns type
# 2. picks template (DE) or (EN) by the customer's language
# 3. opens the email composer on the HELPDESK TICKET if the return belongs to one,
otherwise on the return
# 4. attaches the DHL label + the reclamation form (Retourenschein) from the template

picking = record

def find_label(p):
    return env["ir.attachment"].search([
        ("res_model", "=", "stock.picking"), ("res_id", "=", p.id),
        ("mimetype", "=", "application/pdf"), ("name", "ilike", "LabelReturn")], order="id
desc", limit=1)

def dhl_source_picking(p):
    # same lookup as the BrowseInfo connector uses for its check
    src = env["stock.picking"]
    for move in p.move_ids:
        if move.origin_returned_move_id and move.origin_returned_move_id.picking_id:
            src = move.origin_returned_move_id.picking_id
            break
    if not src and p.origin:
        name = p.origin.replace("Return of", "").strip()
        src = env["stock.picking"].search([("name", "=", name)], limit=1)
    return src if (src and src.carrier_tracking_ref) else env["stock.picking"]
```

```
label = find_label(picking)
if not label:
    # return = created with the Return button OR operation type is a Returns type (e.g.
returns from tickets)
    is_return_type = picking.is_return_picking or
env["stock.picking.type"].search_count([("return_picking_type_id", "=",
picking.picking_type_id.id)])
    if not is_return_type or picking.picking_type_code != "incoming" or picking.state ==
"done":
        raise UserError("%s is not an open return - no return label can be created." %
picking.name)
    carrier = picking.carrier_id
    if not carrier:
        raise UserError("No carrier on %s - please set DHL Parcel DE first." %
picking.name)

    if dhl_source_picking(picking):
        # a) normal case - unchanged
        picking.print_return_label()
    else:
        # b) no outbound DHL shipment -> create the return label directly
        if carrier.delivery_type != "dhl_parcel_de":
            raise UserError("%s has no outbound DHL shipment and the carrier is '%s'.
Please set carrier DHL Parcel DE." % (picking.name, carrier.name))
        partner = picking.partner_id
        if not partner:
            raise UserError("No customer (Receive From) on %s." % picking.name)
        if not picking.dhl_return_receiver_id:
            country = partner.country_id or partner.commercial_partner_id.country_id
            if country and country.code == "DE":
                picking.write({"dhl_return_receiver_id": "deu"})
            else:
                raise UserError("No DHL return receiver for %s (country %s). DHL returns
are currently only set up for Germany - please create the label manually." % (picking.name,
country.name if country else "-"))
        result = env["dhl.request"].create_return_shipment(carrier, picking)
        if not result or not result.get("label_b64"):
            raise UserError("DHL did not return a label for %s. Please check the customer
address." % picking.name)
        tracking_no = result.get("tracking_number")
        att = env["ir.attachment"].create({
            "name": "%s-%s.pdf" % (carrier.get_return_label_prefix(), tracking_no),
```

```
            "type": "binary",
            "datas": result.get("label_b64"),
            "res_model": "stock.picking",
            "res_id": picking.id,
            "mimetype": "application/pdf",
            "description": "System generated DHL Return Label",
        })
        picking.write({"carrier_tracking_ref": tracking_no})
        picking.message_post(
            body="DHL Return shipping label attached. Tracking Number: %s (IQ: created
without outbound DHL shipment)" % tracking_no,
            attachment_ids=[att.id])

    label = find_label(picking)
    if not label:
        raise UserError("The return label was created, but no 'LabelReturn' PDF was found
on %s. Please check the chatter." % picking.name)

lang = (picking.partner_id.lang or "").lower()
key = "(DE)" if lang.startswith("de") else "(EN)"
template = env["mail.template"].search([("model", "=", "stock.picking"), ("name", "ilike",
"Return label for customer " + key)], limit=1)
if not template:
    raise UserError("Email template 'IQ – Return label for customer %s' not found." % key)
tmp = env["mail.compose.message"].create({
    "model": "stock.picking", "res_ids": str([picking.id]),
    "composition_mode": "comment", "template_id": template.id})
subject, body = tmp.subject, tmp.body

ticket = env["helpdesk.ticket"]
# .sudo(): ir.model.fields is readable for administrators only (access error for Elena on
29.10.)
if env["ir.model.fields"].sudo().search_count([("model", "=", "helpdesk.ticket"), ("name",
"=", "picking_ids")]):
    ticket = env["helpdesk.ticket"].search([("picking_ids", "in", picking.ids)], order="id
desc", limit=1)
model, res_id = ("helpdesk.ticket", ticket.id) if ticket else ("stock.picking", picking.id)

composer = env["mail.compose.message"].create({
    "model": model, "res_ids": str([res_id]), "composition_mode": "comment",
    "subject": subject, "body": body,
    "partner_ids": [(6, 0, [picking.partner_id.id])]})
# template attachments are not copied when the composer is created from code -> copy them
```

```
form_ids = [a.copy({"res_model": "mail.compose.message", "res_id": composer.id}).id for a
in template.attachment_ids]
composer.write({"attachment_ids": [(4, label.id)] + [(4, i) for i in form_ids]})
# no tmp.unlink(): server actions may not delete mail.compose.message (access error); Odoo
cleans it up

action = {
    "type": "ir.actions.act_window",
    "name": "Send return label" + (" – Ticket %s" % ticket.display_name if ticket else ""),
    "res_model": "mail.compose.message", "res_id": composer.id,
    "view_mode": "form", "views": [[False, "form"]], "target": "new"}
```

Result: label 545935501591 attached, button switched to “Retourenlabel erneut senden”

## 4. Tests (Production, 12.11.2026)

| Test | Expected | Result |
|---|---|---|
| WH1/RET/00701 – return from ticket, no outbound DHL | Label + IQ chatter note + tracking, email opens | ✓ label 545935501591 |
| Same return → “erneut senden” | No second label, email with same label | open |
| Return button on a DHL delivery | BrowseInfo label as before, no IQ note | open |
| Return button on GLS / old delivery | Label with IQ note | open |
| Return customer outside Germany | Message “only set up for Germany” | open |
| Same as test 1 as Elena | No access error | open |

## 5. Notes & limits

- Only countries with a DHL return receiver – currently Germany ( `deu` ). Finland etc. need DHL Retoure International (procedure 53), requested from DHL sales (Peter Strauch).
- Customer address must be complete (DHL validates; house number fallback “1” in the connector).
- After a BrowseInfo update: check that `create_return_shipment` still exists (read-only grep below) and retest one ticket return.
- DHL return labels are billed only when scanned – unused labels cost nothing.
- The ⚙ Actions menu entry “Send return label” comes from “Create Contextual Action”; can be removed without affecting the buttons.

**Rollback:** paste v1 back (server action: `picking.print_return_label()` only, check `not picking.is_return_picking`; view: `not is_return_picking` instead of `not carrier_id`) – see 29.10 page (code files there are now v2; v1 is in git history).

## 6. Read-only checks

```
 -- Read only: psql -c "<query>"

-- 1. Is a transfer a "real" return (return_id) or created from a ticket (empty)?
SELECT sp.name, sp.return_id, sp.carrier_tracking_ref, sp.sale_id,
sp.dhl_return_receiver_id FROM stock_picking sp WHERE sp.name = 'WH1/RET/00701';

-- 2. Carrier technical name (must be dhl_parcel_de) and Returns operation type link
SELECT id, name, delivery_type FROM delivery_carrier WHERE name ILIKE '%DHL%';
SELECT id, name->>'en_US' AS name, return_picking_type_id FROM stock_picking_type WHERE
code = 'outgoing' AND active;

-- 3. Return labels created without outbound DHL shipment (chatter note)
SELECT m.date, sp.name, left(regexp_replace(m.body,'<[^>]+>','','g'),140) AS note FROM
mail_message m JOIN stock_picking sp ON sp.id = m.res_id AND m.model = 'stock.picking'
WHERE m.body LIKE '%created without outbound DHL shipment%' ORDER BY m.date DESC LIMIT 30;

-- Source lookup in the BrowseInfo connector (read only):
-- cd ~/src/user/bi_delivery_dhl_de_connector && grep -rn "no validated outbound DHL
shipment" .
--   models/stock_picking.py   action_open_return_receiver_wizard  (button "Get Receivers")
--   models/delivery_carrier.py dhl_parcel_de_get_return_label     (Print Return Label)
--   models/dhl_request.py:753 create_return_shipment(carrier, picking)  -> no check, used
by our action
```